LEGAL DUE DILIGENCE REPORT

Project Quartz — Proposed acquisition of Whitmore Thermal Components Limited

Prepared by Whitfield Carter LLP for Ardenfield Capital Partners LLP

Dated 5 February 2026 | Strictly private & confidential | Subject to legal privilege

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report summarises the findings of our legal due diligence on Whitmore Thermal Components Limited (the "Company"), a Sheffield-based manufacturer of micro-channel cold plates and thermal-management assemblies for power electronics, EV and aerospace customers. Our review covered corporate, commercial, IP, employment, property, litigation and tax matters based on the data room (index at Appendix 1 to the Disclosure Letter) and management responses to 4 February 2026.

Overall the Company presents a clean acquisition profile for a deal of this size. We have identified three matters that we recommend be addressed specifically: (i) the change-of-control right in the Northstar Cell supply agreement; (ii) the open HMRC R&D; enquiry for FY2023; and (iii) the pending second-generation cold-plate patent application. None is, in our view, a deal-breaker, but each is reflected in the Disclosure Letter and the risk-allocation mechanics of the SPA.

2. CORPORATE

The Company is a private company limited by shares (number 07744120) incorporated on 14 March 2011. Issued share capital is 1,000,000 ordinary shares of £0.01 held by the three founders and (on exercise of EMI options at completion) eight option holders. The statutory registers are complete and the share transfers to the Buyer can be effected without third-party consent. We recommend the standard completion board minutes and director resignations.

3. COMMERCIAL CONTRACTS

The Company's principal customers are Caldera Mobility Systems plc, Northstar Cell Technologies plc and two tier-1 aerospace primes. The Northstar supply agreement (data room 5.1.4) contains a change-of-control clause permitting Northstar to terminate on 30 days' notice on a change of control. A consent request was issued on 28 January 2026; consent remains outstanding. We recommend completion not be conditional on consent but that the position be disclosed and monitored. A £142,000 warranty-rework provision in respect of a 2025 Caldera batch is reflected in the Management Accounts and the net-debt bridge.

4. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The Company's core value rests in its micro-channel cold-plate designs. The granted patent family (GB2388114, EP3142998, US10,945,332) is in force and registered in the Company's name. A second-generation application (GB2419887.6) is pending and not yet granted; we recommend the Buyer treat continued prosecution as a post-completion integration item. No third-party IP infringement claims are pending or threatened.

5. EMPLOYMENT

The Company employs 84 staff. The EMI option scheme (8 holders, 80,000 shares) will be exercised conditional on completion, with the resulting shares forming part of the Shares sold. One former employee

(T. Hargreaves) has intimated but not issued an unfair dismissal claim; estimated exposure is no more than £18,000. We recommend the standard employment warranties and the indemnity at clause 8 limitations apply.

6. PROPERTY

The Company operates from a single leasehold site (Whitmore Works, Brockhall Road, Sheffield S9 2TG) under a 15-year lease with 9 years unexpired. Replies to CPSE enquiries disclose no material title issues. A finance lease over the vacuum brazing furnace (Pennine Asset Finance, £214,000 outstanding) will be redeemed at completion from the funds flow.

7. TAX

HMRC opened an enquiry into the Company's FY2023 R&D; tax-relief claim on 4 November 2025; it remains open with a maximum estimated additional liability of £61,000. This is covered by the Tax Covenant (Schedule 5 of the SPA) and provided for in the net-debt bridge. We are otherwise not aware of any material unprovided tax liabilities.

8. LITIGATION

Other than the intimated Hargreaves claim (paragraph 5), the Company is not engaged in, and has not been threatened with, any litigation, arbitration or regulatory proceedings of materiality.

9. RECOMMENDED RISK ALLOCATION

We recommend the Buyer rely principally on the buy-side W&I; Policy for warranty recourse, with a Sellers' liability cap (other than for fundamental warranties and tax) negotiated to 10% of the Consideration. The HMRC enquiry and the Northstar consent should be specifically disclosed and tracked. The general warranty claim period is 18 months and the tax claim period 7 years.